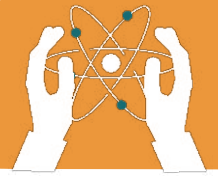


UNIT 3

LIFE CYCLE OF ANIMALS: HEN AND FISH

Learning objectives:

- Understand the stages of the life cycle of a hen and a fish.
- Compare the differences in the life cycle of a hen and a fish.
- Recognize the importance of each stage in the life cycle for reproduction and growth.



Birth, growth, reproduction and death represent the four stages of the life cycles of all animals. In this chapter, we will explore the life cycles of a **hen** and a **fish**. These cycles show how animals grow, change, and reproduce to create the next generation.

Life Cycle of a Hen

Hens who are the member of birds family live up to 6 to 7 years in favourable conditions. Hens are birds, and their life cycle begins with an **egg**.

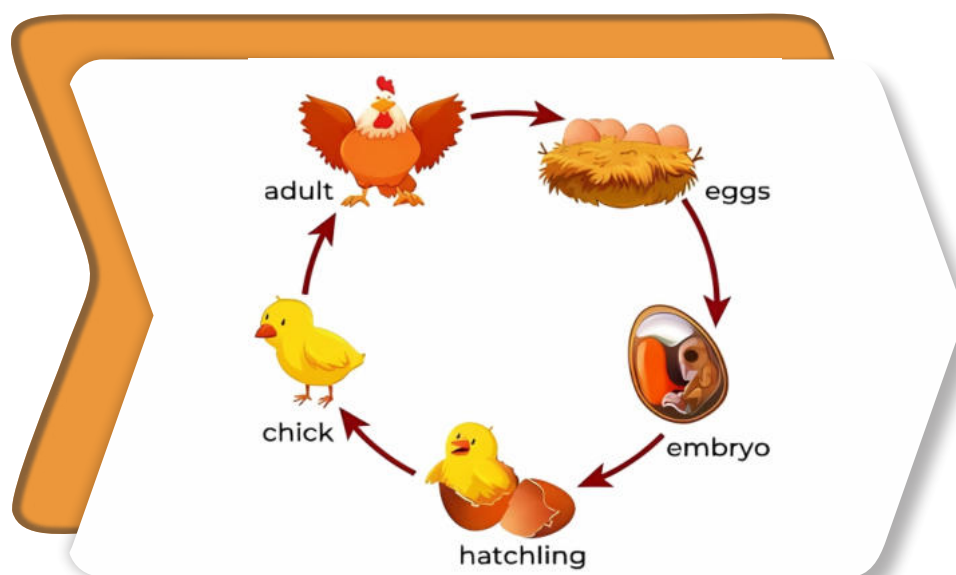
Egg: Hens lay eggs. The egg contains a developing chick inside. It is protected by a hard shell.

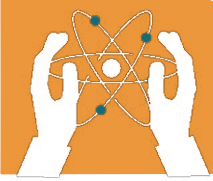
Embryo Development: When a hen sits on the egg to keep it warm (incubation), the embryo inside starts developing. This process takes about 21 days.

Hatchling: After 21 days, the chick hatches out of the egg. It is small, fluffy, and depends on the hen for warmth and protection.

Chick: The hatchling grows into a chick. Chicks start to grow feathers and learn to find food.

Adult Hen: Over time, the chick becomes an adult hen or rooster, capable of laying eggs or reproducing.





Life Cycle of a Fish

Like other animals, fish need to survive and grow large enough to reproduce. Fish are aquatic animals, and their life cycle begins with **eggs** laid in water. Here are the stages:

Egg: It all begins when female fish lay eggs. These eggs are sticky and often stick together and form “**clutches**”. Female fish lay eggs in water, and male fish fertilize them. The eggs are soft and jelly-like.

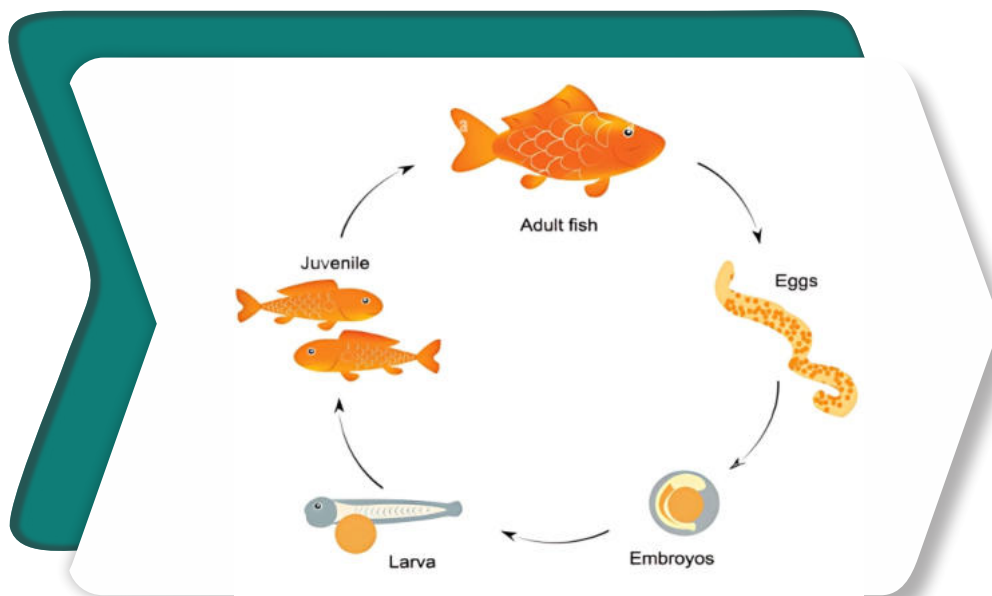
Larva: When the eggs hatch, tiny larvae emerge. The larva has a yolk sac that provides nutrition.

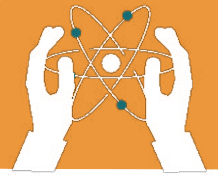
Fish's hatching time vary by species for e.g. Goldfish eggs hatch after about 2–4 days and Nemo fish eggs hatch in about 6 to 10 days.

Fry: As the larvae grow, they develop fins and start swimming. At this stage, they are called fry.

Juvenile: The fry grows bigger and begins to look like an adult fish. They learn to hunt for food and avoid predators.

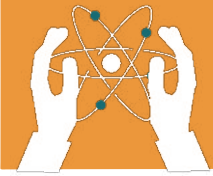
Adult Fish: The juvenile becomes an adult fish capable of reproducing. The cycle begins again when the fish lay eggs.





Comparison: Hen vs Fish Life Cycle

Stage	Hen	Fish
Starting Stage	Egg with a hard shell	Jelly-like eggs in water
Development	Inside the egg (incubation)	In water, fertilized by male
Hatching Time	About 21 days	A few days to weeks
Young Stage	Chick	Fry
Adult Stage	Hen/Rooster	Adult Fish

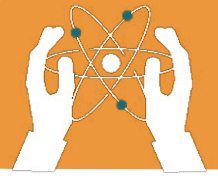


LIFE CYCLE OF ANIMALS HEN AND FISH

Fill in the blanks.

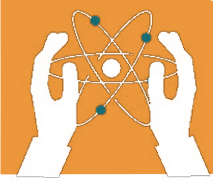
1. Fish eggs are sticky in nature due to which they form _____.
2. Fish lay _____ eggs in water.
3. The process of keeping eggs warm in a hen's life cycle is called _____.
4. The young one of a fish is called a _____ after it grows fins.
5. A hen's egg takes _____ days to hatch.
6. Male fish _____ the eggs laid by female fish.
7. The _____ stage in a hen's life cycle comes after hatching.
8. Fish live in _____ and breathe through gills.

LIFE CYCLE OF ANIMALS HEN AND FISH



Write "T" for True or "F" for False

1. Hens lay eggs with soft shells.
2. Male fish in water fertilize fish eggs.
3. A larva is the stage after the fry in a fish's life cycle.
4. A hen can lay eggs without incubation.
5. Fish need air to breathe through lungs.
6. The chick stage comes after the hatchling stage in a hen's life cycle.
7. The life cycle of a hen takes more time than a fish's life cycle.
8. Juvenile fish look similar to adult fish but are smaller.



Choose the correct answer.

1. What is the first stage in a hen's life cycle?

- Chick
 - Egg
 - Hatchling
 - Adult
-

2. Fish eggs are fertilized?

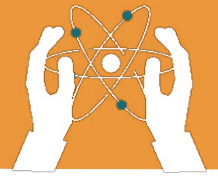
- Inside the female's body
 - By the male fish in water
 - After the fry stage
 - In the juvenile stage
-

3. How long does it take for a hen's egg to hatch?

- 7 days
 - 14 days
 - 21 days
 - 30 days
-

4. What is the name of a fish that has grown fins and can swim?

- Egg
 - Larva
 - Fry
 - Juvenile
-



5. The young one of a hen is called a:

- Chick
 - Hatchling
 - Rooster
 - Egg
-

6. What do fish use to breathe underwater?

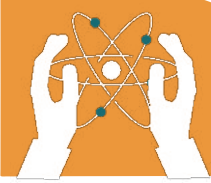
- Lungs
 - Gills
 - Fins
 - Scales
-

7. Which stage comes after the larva in a fish's life cycle?

- Egg
 - Juvenile
 - Fry
 - Adult
-

8. Which of the following is NOT a stage in the life cycle of a hen?

- Egg
 - Fry
 - Chick
 - Adult
-



Answer the following questions.

Q1. How fish life is different from bird's life?

Q2. Why do hens sit on their eggs?

Q3. What is the role of the yolk sac in a fish's larva stage?

Q4. What do you know about birds?

Q5. Name the stage in which a fish develops fins and starts swimming.

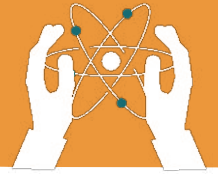
Q6. How does the life cycle of a fish depend on water?

Q7. Why is it important for adult animals to reproduce?



Critical Thinking

What factors affect the development of embryo?



Identifying the parts of boiled egg



ACTIVITY

Take a boiled egg of a hen and gently peel off the shell. Identify its parts: shell, yolk, and white. Discuss how the shell protects the embryo.